

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Senior Manager, Model Validation (Questbank) candidate with ~7 years across independent model review, validation, and risk governance at Moody's Analytics, EY, and Ortec Finance. Operates within a formal model-governance framework with delegated sign-off on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs, assessing conceptual soundness, data quality, and economic defensibility. Strong statistical modeling and Python foundation; applied familiarity with OSFI E-23, IFRS 9 credit risk / ECL. CFA charter plus dual MSc.

CORE SKILLS

Independent Model Validation & Challenge • Model Risk & Governance (OSFI E-23-aligned) • Statistical Modeling & Machine Learning • Credit Risk & Expected Credit Loss (ECL) / IFRS 9 • Credit & Financial Risk Analytics • Conceptual Soundness & Data Quality Assessment • Python & SQL • R & MATLAB • Validation Reporting & Stakeholder Communication

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director - Modelling Services (Investment & Risk Lead)

Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Independent Validation & Model Governance

- Hold delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios (\$5-25bn per engagement, \$50bn+ cumulative) - independently reviewing curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions prior to production release.
- Member of the model governance committee - contributing to methodology review, documentation and benchmarking standards, and model-performance assessment for client-delivered analytics.
- Operate within a formal model-governance framework: review assumptions, assess conceptual soundness and economic defensibility, and escalate outputs lacking mathematical support - with documentation aligned to SR 11-7 and OSFI E-23 expectations.
- Validate derivatives pricing outputs across rates, FX, and inflation, ensuring consistency of sensitivities and scenario impacts at portfolio-level aggregates.

Data Quality, Stress Testing & Reporting

- Review aggregation logic converting security-level exposures into portfolio-level risk metrics, assessing data quality and suitability feeding downstream analytics.
- Led design of a multi-asset cash flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios, embedding behavioral assumptions and macro overlays.
- Prepared validation reports and analytical summaries for senior stakeholders and clients' Heads of Risk, translating quantitative findings into decision-ready narratives.
- Built agentic AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) automating validation scaffolding, anomaly detection, and documentation - reducing cycle time an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.

Client Service Specialist

Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to the PFaroe DB and PFaroe PM analytics platforms; validated model outputs post-deployment.
- Served as technical liaison between client investment teams and product/development functions, translating requirements into structured development requests.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant - IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation

Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 (credit risk / ECL) transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients, aligning regulatory requirements with model implementation and financial-reporting frameworks.

- Advised actuarial, IT, finance, and program-management functions on IFRS 9 / IFRS 17 adoption; contributed to governance documentation and regulatory-readiness processes.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant - Asset-Liability Management & Risk

Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Built and validated stochastic economic scenario generators assessing interest-rate risk and funding volatility under base-case and stressed environments.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR using Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition and robustness testing of allocation recommendations.
- Led development and validation of the model capturing all Funding Policy dynamics for a three-plan university pension merger, evaluating duration, currency, inflation, and leverage strategies.
- Presented model findings and risk analyses to investment committees at Canadian pension-fund clients.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016